

44 What you can and can't do

Use "can" to talk about the things you are able to do, such as ride a bicycle or play the guitar. Use "cannot" or "can't" for things you are not able to do.

⚙️ **New language** "Can," "can't," and "cannot"

Aa **Vocabulary** Talents and abilities

🧩 **New skill** Saying what you can and can't do

44.1 KEY LANGUAGE "CAN / CANNOT / CAN'T"

"Can" goes between the subject and the verb. The verb after "can" changes to its base form (the infinitive without "to").

TIP

The long negative form "cannot" is always spelled as one word, not two words.

I **can** ride a bicycle.

Base form of verb.



He **can** play the guitar.

"Can" is always the same. It doesn't change with the subject.



I { **cannot** / **can't** } sing jazz songs.

Short form of "cannot."



44.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES "CAN / CANNOT / CAN'T"



Janet **can** play tennis.



He **cannot** climb the tree.



Bob **can** swim well.



They **can't** lift the box.



44.3 HOW TO FORM "CAN / CANNOT / CAN'T"

SUBJECT	"CAN / CANNOT / CAN'T"	BASE FORM	OBJECT
She	can cannot can't	ride	a bicycle.